MIL-R-37725B
23 June 1981
SUPERSEDING
MIL-R-37725A(DLA-DM)
3 August 1979

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

REBREATHING BAG, GAS ANESTHESIA APPARATUS, DISPOSABLE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers disposable, conductive, anesthesia breathing circuits with bacteria-retentive filter, suitable for use in the administration of anesthesia.

1.2 Classification. The breathing circuits shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I. - Swivel connector.
Type II. - Rigid connector with adapter.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6515

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MILITARY

MIL-M-36954 - Mask, Surgical, Disposable.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

NATIONAL FIRE PROTECTION ASSOCIATION

NFPA No. 56A Standard For the Use of Inhalation Anesthetics.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Fire Protection Association, 470 Atlantic Avenue, Boston, MA 02210.)

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI)

ANSI Z79.2 American National Standard for Tracheal Tube Connectors and Adapters.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

COMPRESSED GAS ASSOCIATION, INC. (CGA)

CGA M-1 Standard for 22mm Anesthesia Breathing Circuit Connectors.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Compressed Gas Association, Inc., 500 Fifth Avenue, New York, NY 10036.)

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UNDERWRITERS' LABORATORIES, INC. (UL)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., 207 East Ohio Street, Chicago, IL 60611, 333 Pfingsten Road, Northbrook, IL 60062, 1285 Walt Whitman Road, Melville, LI, NY 11746 or 1655 Scott Boulevard, Santa Clara, CA 95050.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Fire and casualty hazards.

3.1.1 All components. All components of each breathing circuit assembly shall comply with the fire and casualty hazards provisions of the applicable standards for operation in hazardous locations, Class 1, Group C, and as prescribed by NFPA No. 56A, and be an approved type for the purpose intended, as determined by a nationally recognized testing agency, adequately equipped and competent to perform such services, as shall be evidenced by the attachment of its seal, stamp, or label to the article, or issuance of a certificate. The stamp, label, seal, or certificate of the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., or other testing laboratory approved by the contracting agency shall be considered acceptable evidence of each approval. However, in addition to the aforementioned, the contracting agency reserves the right to require the contractor to submit a laboratory test report which shall include test results and methods used to determine conformance.

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Rebreathing bag. The rebreathing bag shall be fabricated from conductive latex rubber. The 22 millimeter (mm) bag inlet connector shall be fabricated from flexible, conductive rubber or plastic suitable for the intended purpose.

3.2.2 Breathing tubes. The breathing tubes shall be fabricated from flexible, conductive, corrugated polyethylene or a combination of polyethylene and synthetic rubber.

3.2.3 Filter assembly, swivel "Y"-connector, rigid "Y"-connector, right-angle elbow adapter, connecting components and fittings. Shall be fabricated from conductive materials, suitable in all respects for the

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purpose intended. The 22 mm inlet female connector of the filter assembly shall be fabricated from semi-rigid, flexible, plastic suitable for the intended purpose. The swivel "Y"-connector, rigid "Y"-connector and right-angle elbow adapter shall be fabricated from rigid material.

3.3 Style, design and dimensions. Shall be a disposable, conductive, anesthesia breathing circuit suitable for the administration of anesthesia when connected to a conventional anesthesia apparatus. The breathing circuit shall consist of a 0.5 micron (nominal rating) bacteria-retentive filter, two flexible breathing tubes, a rebreathing bag of 3-liter capacity and an integral "Y"-connector component that shall be suitable for attachment to a face mask. The two types of breathing circuits specified herein, shall be as follows:

Type I. The type I unit shall possess a built-in swivel "Y"-connector, capable of 180° minimum rotation of the lower leg (patient end). The exposed opening of the swivel connector (patient end) shall be internally tapered to accept 15 mm endotracheal connectors or adapters that are in accordance with ANSI Z79.2, in a leakproof manner. The breathing tubes shall be securely attached to the upper arms of the swivel "Y"-connector.

Type II. The type II unit shall possess a built-in rigid "Y"-connector, securely attached to both breathing tubes, and a right-angle elbow adapter assembled to the patient end of the "Y" (lower leg). The elbow adapter shall form a completely rotatable mask connection. The opening of the rigid "Y"-connector shall be internally tapered to accept 15 mm endotracheal connectors or adapters that are in accordance with ANSI Z79.2, in a leakproof manner. The patient end of the right-angle adapter shall possess a standard tapered 22 mm external connection and a 15 mm internal tapered connection to accommodate 15 mm endotracheal connectors or adapters that are in accordance with ANSI Z79.2. The machine end of the adapter shall form a standard external 15 mm connection, tapered in accordance with ANSI Z79.2, and form a tight, leakproof junction with the rigid "Y"-connector.

The filter assembly may be furnished attached to one of the breathing tubes, or furnished as a loose, individually wrapped, component. The filter assembly shall easily form a leakproof junction when assembled to the breathing tube. The bacteriological filter shall be designed to prevent cross-contamination during the administration of anesthesia. The filter inlet shall be capable of forming a secure, leakproof junction when connected to a standard 22 mm external tapered connection. All open ends of the breathing tubes shall be capable of forming a secure, leakproof

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junction when connected to a 22 mm external tapered connection. The rebreathing tubes shall be of the corrugated type and shall not be capable of taking a permanent set (i.e., shall be resilient and possess good draping characteristics).

The rebreathing bag shall possess a flexible fitting, designed to form a leakproof junction when connected to a 22 mm external tapered connection. All junctions that are specified to be leakproof shall be considered to be leakproof when they pass the leakage test specified in 3.7. For clarity, the term "breathing circuit proper" shall be those components that are assembled as an integral unit; the term "breathing circuit" shall include the rebreathing bag.

The following dimensions shall apply:

Breathing tube:	
Length	- 34 to 40 inches
Rebreathing bag:	
Length	- 13-1/2 inches (reference dimension)
Wall thickness on flat surfaces	- .010 inch minimum

3.3.1 Standard connectors. All tubing connectors or opened ends of breathing tubes, rebreathing bag inlet, and 22 mm filter connection shall be tested for tensile test (including proper engagement) and pressure test specified in paragraphs 6.1.1 and 6.1.2 of CGA pamphlet M-1. Any connectors or connections that fail any portion of these tests shall be rejected. The opening of the swivel or rigid "Y"-connector and the external 15 mm end (machine end) of the right-angle adapter shall pass the gauging test specified in paragraphs 7.4 and 7.4.1 of ANSI Z79.2.

3.4 Bacteria filter assembly. When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the bacteria filter assembly shall not allow passage of more than 10 percent of a monodisperse di-octyl phthalate (DOP), having a diameter of 0.3 microns at a flow rate of 28 liters per minute (LPM). The filter media shall be completely encased and shall not be affected by anesthetic gases or volatile agents. As an alternate test, the bacteria filter assembly shall show an average bacterial filtration efficiency of not less than 99 percent, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

3.5 Rebreathing bag. When tested as specified in 4.4.2, there shall be no evidence of bag leakage or rupture. Further, when tested as specified in 4.4.3, the rebreathing bag shall withstand the accelerated aging test without becoming tacky or brittle or decreasing in tensile strength by more than 25 percent.

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3.6 Security of assembly. When tested as specified in 4.4.4, all tubing junctions with swivel or rigid "Y"-connector, filter assembly, and 22 mm female tubing end bushings (when applicable), shall not separate or loosen. In addition, the rebreathing bag inlet connection shall not separate or loosen when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.7 Leakage. When tested as specified in 4.4.5, leakage shall not exceed 100 cubic centimeters per minute (cc/min).

3.8 Pressure drop.

3.8.1 Pressure drop - dry system. The pressure drop of the breathing circuit proper shall not exceed 3 inches of water, when tested as specified in 4.4.6. As an alternate, the mean pressure drop of the filter assembly shall not be greater than 4 mm of water, when tested as specified in 4.4.6.1.

3.8.2 Pressure drop - saturated air. The filter shall not have a pressure drop exceeding 5 mm of water, when tested as specified in 4.4.6.2.

3.9 Conductivity. When tested as specified in 4.4.7, the rebreathing bag shall have a maximum resistance of 1,000,000 ohms. The breathing circuit proper, with all components assembled (excluding the rebreathing bag), shall have a maximum measured resistance of 1,000,000 ohms.

3.10 Instructions. Each breathing circuit shall be provided with instructions for use.

3.11 Identification marking. The name or registered trademark of the manufacturer shall appear on at least one of the breathing circuit's components.

3.12 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Components shall be free from holes, cracks, tears, sharp edges, blocked openings, foreign matter and any other defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein

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unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the materials may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one complete breathing circuit.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5

4.2.2 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one complete breathing circuit. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Dimensions	3.3	---	S-2	1.5
Standard connectors	3.3.1	CGA-M1 and ANSI Z79.2	S-2	1.5
Bacteria filter assembly	3.4	4.4.1 or 4.4.1.1	S-2	1.5
Rebreathing bag				
Leakage	3.5	4.4.2	S-3	1.5
Accelerated aging	3.5	4.4.3	S-1	1.5
Security of assembly	3.6	4.4.4	S-3	1.5
Leakage	3.7	4.4.5	S-3	1.5
Pressure drop				
Dry system	3.8.1	4.4.6 or 4.4.6.1	S-3	1.5
Saturated air	3.8.2	4.4.6.2	S-3	1.5
Electrical conductivity	3.9	4.4.7	S-4	1.0

4.3 Examination. The breathing circuit shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any breathing circuits in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective items in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Breathing circuit not furnished complete with all specified components for appropriate type and NSN.
102	Breathing circuit not of the design specified for the appropriate type and NSN.
103	Rebreathing bag not of 3-liter capacity.
104	Breathing tubes not of flexible construction.
105	Swivel "Y"-connector not capable of at least 180° rotation for type I units.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects. - Continued

Categories	Defects
Major	
106	Elbow adapter of type II units not completely rotatable with respect to rigid "Y"-connector.
107	Inlet ports and passageways not free from foreign matter or occlusions.
108	Instructions for use not provided.
109	Components not free from holes, cracks, tears, sharp edges, or foreign matter.
110	Rebreathing tubes cannot be easily assembled to filter assembly (when filter is furnished as a separate component).
Minor	
201	Identification markings not as specified in 3.11.

4.3.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit packaging, packing, and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Bacteria filter retention test. The AIR TECHNIQUES Q 127 DOP Penetrometer (or equivalent device) shall be used to measure the efficacy of the bacteria filter assembly. The bacteria filter assembly may be tested as a separate component and need not be severed from the breathing circuit proper. The DOP Penetrometer shall be used to form the particles sized as specified in 3.4 at 25°C. The percentage penetration shall be determined with the use of the DOP Penetrometer, as specified above, by simultaneously sampling the DOP media upstream and downstream of the filter assembly and measuring the percentage of DOP in each stream. Operation of the DOP Penetrometer shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's manual. Accuracy of the DOP Penetrometer shall be sufficient to detect the percentage penetration specified.

4.4.1.1 Bacteria filter retention test (alternate test). Cultures --- Staphylococcus aureus, Utah strain 15 cultures shall be transferred at least three times in nutrient broth (BBL) before preparation of the test

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suspension. Each transfer shall be incubated at 37° + 2°C for 24 to 48 hours, and constantly agitated throughout the incubation period on a mechanical shaker.

The efficiency of each filter shall be tested with the Andersen sampler shown in MIL-M-36954, figure 1. The schematic testing arrangement shall be essentially as shown in MIL-M-36954, figure 2, except the components from the bottom of the Andersen sampler (outlet) shall be a calibrated flowmeter in line with a vacuum pump or compressor. The bacteria filter shall be placed between the aerosol chamber and the Andersen sampler in a leakproof manner. The Andersen sampler shall be utilized to collect and count bacteria on nutrient agar or Trypticase soy agar (BBL) in special petri dishes.

The bacterial culture shall be first diluted to a given turbidity as measured by an adequate optical instrument such that when the optically adjusted suspension is diluted approximately 1/3500, the nutrient agar control plates will yield a total colony count of 1700 to 2700 colonies. The diluted culture suspension shall be admitted into a nebulizer from a syringe driven by a constant drive mechanism. The nebulizer shall be operated at 15 pounds per square inch pressure (psig) to produce an aerosol in the aerosol chamber. The aerosol shall be drawn through the apparatus at a flow rate of 28.3 LPM for one minute to establish control values. The air flow shall be measured by a calibrated flowmeter. At the end of 1-minute aerosolization, the constant drive mechanism shall be turned off and the chamber and sampler washed with 28.3 liters of air. The control plates shall be removed from the sampler and replaced immediately with fresh nutrient agar plates. Each filter to be tested shall be interposed, in turn, at the point where the aerosol chamber is attached to the Andersen sampler. The bacterial aerosol shall again be drawn through the apparatus, identical to the control run, except that the sample filter shall be in the circuit. The filtration efficiency shall be as follows:

$$\text{Percent Biological Efficiency} = (C-F) \div C)\ (100)$$

Where C = the average number of colonies on control plates
F = number of colonies on test plates (filter material interposed).

4.4.2 Leakage test (rebreathing bag). The rebreathing bag shall be inflated with an internal air pressure of 25 mm Hg with a suitable manometer placed into the circuit. The bag shall then be placed into a suitable container of water and observed for leakage as evidenced by the formation of air bubbles.

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4.4.3 Accelerated aging test (rebreathing bag). The rebreathing bag shall be placed into an air oven for seven days at a temperature of 156° to 160°F (68.9° to 71.1°C).

4.4.4 Security of assembly. With the "Y"-connector suitably clamped and the breathing circuit hanging vertically downward, a 10-pound axial force shall be applied to each tubing junction, and all permanently secured junctions. A 15-pound axial force shall also be applied to the 22 mm female connection of the rebreathing bag.

4.4.5 Leakage test (breathing circuit). A suitably calibrated flowmeter and mercury manometer shall be used to test leakage of the breathing circuit proper. The filter assembly shall be assembled to one of the tubes, if not permanently attached to the rebreathing tube, and the right-angle elbow adapter attached to the "Y"-connector (when applicable). With the opening of the filter assembly and the swivel "Y"-connector (type I unit) or the right-angle elbow adapter (type II unit) each suitably plugged air pressure of 15 mm Hg shall be internally admitted to the opening of the other breathing tube. The manometer shall be inserted into the circuit between the controlled air supply and the breathing tube opening, with the calibrated flowmeter between the breathing tube opening and the manometer. The stabilized flow, as indicated by the flowmeter, shall be recorded.

4.4.6 Pressure drop test - breathing circuit (dry system). A flowmeter with a capacity of at least 120 LPM and a water manometer shall be used to test the pressure drop of the breathing circuit proper. With the opening of swivel "Y"-connector (type I unit) or the patient end of the right-angle elbow adapter (type II unit) suitably plugged, air at a flow rate of 95 to 100 LPM shall be admitted to the inlet of the filter assembly, with the filter assembly secured to the rebreathing tube, and the opening of the other breathing tube open to atmosphere. A suitable manometer shall be inserted in the circuit between the flowmeter and the inlet of the filter assembly. The reading of the manometer shall be recorded in inches of water and shall be considered to be the pressure drop of the breathing circuit proper.

4.4.6.1 Pressure drop test - filter assembly (dry system) alternate method. A single sloped U-shaped water manometer, or other appropriate device, shall be used to test the pressure drop across the filter assembly. Air flow shall be measured by a calibrated flowmeter. Air shall be admitted to the filter inlet at a rate of 8 LPM. Each side of the filter assembly shall be pneumatically connected to the arms of the manometer. The pressure drop across the filter shall be the vertical displacement (difference in the water columns of the manometer arms) of the water in the

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manometer. The vertical displacement shall be the sine of the angle of the manometer from the horizontal plane, multiplied by the difference in the manometer columns.

4.4.6.2 Pressure drop test - filter assembly (saturated air). The filter assembly shall be tested for pressure drop using saturated air in the manner specified in 4.4.6.1, or similar arrangement. Air shall be admitted through a humidifier at 5 to 8 LPM with the saturated vapor at 35° to 39°C admitted to the filter inlet for a period of 4 hours. A calibrated flowmeter and appropriate manometer shall be in the pneumatic circuit. After the 4-hour exposure of saturated vapor, the pressure drop across the filter assembly shall be measured and recorded.

4.4.7 Electrical conductivity. All components of the breathing circuit proper and the rebreathing bag shall be conditioned in air at ambient room temperature with relative humidity not greater than 80 percent for not less than 24 hours. The samples shall then be tested under the same conditions. The resistance between the electrodes shall be measured by a resistance measuring apparatus as specified in NFPA No. 56A, section 465.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Individual package. Each breathing circuit shall be clean, neatly arranged and packaged in a sealed polyethylene bag. Each bag shall be provided with instructions for use placed on the bag or within the bag in such a manner so as to be readily identified.

5.1.1.2 Unit package. Ten individually packaged circuits of one type only shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. Ten circuits individually packaged, as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be further packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Four unit packages containing circuits of one type only shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Four unit packages containing circuits of one type only shall be packaged in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged circuits shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package. Each individual package shall be marked in accordance with the contractor's commercial practice.

5.3.2 Unit packages and shipping containers. Each unit package and shipping container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type required (see 1.2).
c. Applicable NSN.
d. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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6.2 NSN coverage. This specification covers the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

NSN	Item Identification	Specification Designation
6515-00-476-5239	REBREATHING BAG, GAS ANESTHESIA APPARATUS, Swivel "Y", Disposable, 10s	Type I
6515-01-045-3341	REBREATHING BAG, GAS ANESTHESIA APPARATUS, Rigid "Y", Right-Angle Elbow, Disposable, 10s	Type II

6.3 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DoD-MB

Agent:
DLA-DM

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-R-37725B

REBREATHING BAG, GAS ANESTHESIA APPARATUS, DISPOSABLE

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

1. ☐ HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

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